

August

6

1926

Speedy swimmer

US athlete Gertrude Ederle became the first woman to swim the English Channel, beating the men's record by two hours. During her swim, she faced huge waves, freezing temperatures, and jellyfish.



Born this day

1955 Lucille Ball, US actor. A well-known entertainer, she starred in popular sitcoms and was the first woman to lead a major Hollywood studio.

1945 Attack on Hiroshima

During World War II, the USA dropped an atomic bomb – the first one used in war – on Hiroshima, Japan. Almost 80,000 people died immediately. Thousands more later died from radiation exposure.



1960

Do the Twist

After Black American singer Chubby Checker performed “The Twist” on *The Dick Clark Show*, a new dance trend, involving a twisting movement of the hips, spread across the USA.



Also on this day

1965 US president Lyndon Johnson signed the Voting Rights Act, making it illegal for election officials to discriminate against Black voters.

1991 The world's first website went live – it was created by British computer scientist Tim Berners-Lee.

2015 Scientists in Hong Kong revealed the first interactive ant map, which tracked the whereabouts of ants all around the world.